



CHILDREN play in the Strait of Hormuz off Bandar Abbas, Iran, as smoke rises from an explosion on Monday.

## Trump says toll coming for strait passage

President announces Iranian ships will be blocked and others will pay a 20% fee.

By JON GAMBRELL AND JOSH BOAK

DUBAI — The U.S. announced a new round of strikes on Iran on Monday, hours after President Trump said that the United States is “reinstating” a blockade on Iran in the Strait of Hormuz and, in a seeming policy reversal, will charge other ships for safe passage. Iran has insisted it controls the critical waterway, as another exchange of fire threatened a return to all-out war.

The U.S. had until now said the strait should remain open to all without tolls, as it was before the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran on Feb. 28. Any attempt by the U.S. or Iran to charge fees would violate global norms on freedom of navigation and raise tensions, probably causing further economic disruption far beyond the region.

The new round of attacks followed Trump telling conservative radio host Hugh Hewitt, “We’re going to hit them very hard tonight and we’re going to hit them hard tomorrow — and there’s not a damn thing they can do about it.”

“They have nothing,” Trump added. “They have nothing going, other than [See Iran, A3]

## ‘Dangerous heat’ to broil the Southland this week

Triple-digit forecast raises health and fire concerns

By GRACE TOOHEY AND SEAMUS BOZEMAN

A major heat wave across California’s interior is expected to push temperatures into the triple digits this week, further elevating the fire threat and raising concerns about health risks.

“We have a long duration of very warm to hot temperatures that will worsen during the week,” said Ariel Cohen, a meteorologist at the National Weather Service in Oxnard.

According to the weather service’s Monday forecast discussion, this warming trend “will give way to dangerous heat by mid week,”

with temperatures climbing from San Luis Obispo County down to the border with Mexico in San Diego County. Widespread heat advisories have been issued for much of the region through Friday, with the exception of beach cities.

Beginning Tuesday morning, an extreme heat watch will go into effect, when officials warn of “dangerously hot conditions with temperatures of 95 to 105 possible.”

“There is a high risk for dangerous heat illness for anyone, especially for the very young, the very old, those without air conditioning, and those active outdoors,” the heat advisory

said.

Highs by Wednesday away from the coast will range from 90 to 105 degrees in most of the region, the weather service warned. The San Fernando Valley probably will see the most extreme temperatures, with Woodland Hills expected to hit 110 degrees Wednesday. The Antelope Valley also could near 110 degrees, while Santa Clarita will be close behind at 105 or 106 degrees, forecasters said.

Low temperatures across the region probably will remain in the 70s even overnight, providing little relief and exacerbating health concerns.

[See Heat, A8]

## Keep Kahlo in Mexico, suit says

Many fear trove will go to Europe and never return

By Patrick J. McDonnell and Cecilia Sánchez Vidal

MEXICO CITY — Many soccer aficionados in town for the World Cup took time out for a change-of-pace culture fix: a visit to an emblematic collection of 20th century Mexican art, featuring signature works of Frida Kahlo, the taboo-breaking painter turned global feminist icon.

“Fabulous,” concluded Álvaro Muñoz, 41 a university professor from Colombia, after viewing the paintings of Kahlo and others. But Muñoz was shocked to learn that many Mexicans fear that the private collection’s future in Mexico may



Mexican government “DIEGO on My Mind” and other pieces are set to travel for two years.

be in doubt. “The paintings are the patrimony of all Mexicans,” he said.

The works are scheduled to go on display in Europe, and the trove’s impending departure has ignited one of Mexico’s most heated cultural controversies in recent memory.

Hundreds of intellectuals and others have signed letters and online petitions expressing fears of a disastrous denouement: the collection’s prolonged — and possibly permanent — absence from Mexico.

[See Kahlo, A3]

## Empty for decades, lot to get temporary art park

A long-vacant lot in the shadow of City Hall is being converted into an “art park” — but some downtown Los Angeles residents and a powerful union aren’t pleased about the deal and how it went down.

The nonprofit AltaMed Health Services is paying the city \$175,000 to lease the two-acre space on 1st Street and Broadway through February 2027. At the site, AltaMed plans to build “El Corazón Art Park,” featuring an art gallery to showcase Mexican and Chicano works, 30 boxed trees and a health center — along with a 20-foot video screen.

The plan has faced backlash from some community members frustrated about a deal they feel was hashed out behind closed doors. Residents had long been promised a city-owned and -operated park at the lot, and some fear AltaMed has more permanent plans for

But there’s already backlash over the 2-acre plot’s new use

By Noah Goldberg



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times LESLIE RIDINGS, left, and Cassidy Horton of the Downtown Los Angeles Residents Assn. visit the lot.

the space.

“For a half-century this space has been surrounded by beautiful buildings and parks, and it is a failure that it has not been utilized,” said Jens Midthun, the head of the Downtown Los Angeles Neighborhood Council. “We want the people who are going to use the park to be a part of the process. That’s not what happened this time.”

AltaMed runs more than 40 medical centers in Southern California, with nearly 6,000 employees. It focuses on Latino and multiethnic areas as part of its declared mission to eliminate disparities in healthcare access.

Its chief executive, Cástulo de la Rocha, served on Mayor Karen Bass’ transition team after she won the mayor’s race in 2022. De la Rocha and more than a dozen other executives at AltaMed also gave the maxi-

[See Park, A8]

## California joins lawsuit to block Paramount deal

Twelve states are challenging Warner Bros. merger, calling it antitrust violation.

By MEG JAMES

California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta and 11 other Democratic state attorneys general filed a lawsuit Monday to block Paramount Skydance’s proposed nearly \$11-billion takeover of Warner Bros. Discovery — a last-ditch effort to derail a deal that would transform Hollywood.

Tech scion David Ellison’s proposed merger has been hurtling toward the finish line after securing approvals from the U.S. Justice Department and numerous foreign governments. President Trump, an ally of Ellison’s billionaire father, Larry Ellison, favors the deal. Trump is eager for a big shake-up at CNN, which is controlled by Warner Bros.

David Ellison now faces his biggest challenge yet as he attempts to build a new entertainment behemoth.

The 37-page lawsuit, filed in federal court in San Francisco, alleges that the proposed merger — one of the largest in Hollywood — would violate the U.S. Clayton Act, a century-old antitrust law to prevent mergers that weaken competition and raise costs for consumers.

The proposed merger “would extinguish competition,” Bonta said during a Monday news conference in the Hollywood Hills with the landmark Hollywood sign as his backdrop. “It would result in higher prices, lower content quality, and fewer movies and TV shows.”

“Movie theaters, basic cable TV distributors and audiences on every sofa and in every movie seat would feel the impact of this unlawful merger,” Bonta said.

Paramount, in a statement, blasted the suit, calling it “a fundamentally flawed application of the antitrust laws” and a veiled attempt to protect streaming giants, including Netflix.

“We will vigorously defend the transaction and demonstrate that this challenge is inconsistent with [See Lawsuit, A12]

## UC rescinds plan to evaluate testing

Study on whether to use SAT or ACT in admissions process is abruptly put on hold.

By JAWEED KALEEM

The University of California admissions board has voted to rescind — for now — its plan to study whether to resume SAT or ACT requirements in admissions, a move that leaves the direction of one of the university’s most closely watched debates unclear a day before the Board of Regents meets in San Francisco.

UC’s Board of Admissions and Relations with Schools, known as BOARS, announced last month that it would convene two work groups through next year: one to weigh the role of standardized tests in admissions, the other to reexamine high school course requirements for acceptance to UC.

At a Friday meeting, the board voted to pull back on the plan, and the links that explained it — which appeared on the UC website late last week — have been removed. There is no replacement plan as of yet, according to two members of the board who attended the meeting, and several UC professors who are aware of the decision and who have been advocating either for or against testing requirements.

The decision shelves, possibly for months, a process UC said would be a careful, evidence-driven review that was praised by UC President James B. Milliken as “comprehensive.”

It is unclear why the plan was suspended. A UC spokesperson and the chair of the admissions board, UC Riverside professor David Volz, did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

The plan had faced criticism on multiple fronts — [See Study, A7]



MATT SLOCUM Associated Press

### POCKETS TOO DEEP?

With Tarik Skubal a potential trade acquisition for the Dodgers, stars consider whether L.A. is just being greedy, Bill Shaikin writes. **SPORTS, B10**

### ICE shoots, kills driver in Maine

Advocates say he’s a 26-year-old father from Colombia. It is the second such killing in a week. **NATION, A5**

**Weather** Mostly sunny; warm. L.A. Basin: 87/69. **B6**

**Markets** ..... **A12**  
**Opinion Voices** ..... **A13**

### Judge criticizes Trump’s IRS suit

President’s \$10-billion complaint is denounced as an exercise in self-dealing. **NATION, A6**

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